STRATEGIES FOR COMPETING IN INDUSTRIES AND MARKETS

Dual Degree in Business Administration & Data and Business Analytics
BBADBA SEP-2026 SCIM-NBDA.3.M.B

Area Strategy
Number of sessions: 30
Academic year: 26-27
Degree course: THIRD
Number of credits: 6.0
Semester: 1º
Category: COMPULSORY
Language: English

Professor: **RICARDO LOPEZ PEREZ**

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Ricardo López Pérez obtained the PhD. graduated "cum laude" in Business Administration and Management from Universidad Autónoma de Madrid (UAM). He is also MBA at IE Business School, graduated as a top five student, Master in finance by EOI and Master in Capital Markets by IBME. He works as strategic and financial consultant for public organizations. Prior to that, he has worked for the Spanish Stock Exchange (BME) at several financial positions, including investors relations and treasury.
He is currently Professor of Corporate Strategy at IE University (Madrid, Spain). Prior joining IE University, he has been professor of Strategy at Universidad Politécnica de Madrid (UPM) and Universidad Autónoma de Madrid (UAM). Ricardo is passionate about corporate and business strategy. His research interests are "The creation of new business models within mature industries"; "The impact of Corporate culture on Strategy" and "Social Business models".

Office Hours

Office hours will be on request. Please contact at:

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SUBJECT DESCRIPTION

"Strategy is a plan, a method, a series of actions designed to achieve a specific goal or effect"

(Wordsmyth Dictionary)

This course aims to assist you in becoming an effective and responsible strategist, able to critically evaluate existing strategies of firms, and make well-grounded recommendations directing the future of organizations.

We will start by examining reasons why some firms outperform other firms—one of the most fundamental questions in the field of strategy. We systematically examine what drives profitability differences across industries and how firms can effectively adapt strategy to their industry. We then explore how firms can distinguish themselves from competitors within their industry and create a competitive advantage. You will learn key tools and frameworks to navigate a firm's corporate strategy—where to compete?—and business strategy—how to compete?

In the second half of the course will focus on strategizing in increasingly dynamic and unpredictable environments. We will learn how to incorporate potential moves from competitors, artificial intelligence, and sustainability goals in a firm's strategy and current challenges in developing an effective, timely, and responsible strategy.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

The purpose of this course is to develop participants' ability to **think strategically** and to provide suitable tools and knowledge to understand how companies can achieve and sustain competitive advantage. The course is designed to:

- Learn how to analyze industries and the competitive position of firms
- Learn how firms create value and competitive advantage
- Learn how firms sustain competitive advantage over time
- Learn how to critically evaluate firms' existing strategies and develop effective, timely, and responsible strategies
- Learn how to make well-grounded recommendations directing firms' future strategy through practical examples

The course will use core tools and frameworks of strategic management to understand how firms can **incorporate sustainability goals** in their strategy and create responsible strategies. Course participants will:

- Learn to understand and analyze business strategies that drive positive change
- Learn how firms can create competitive advantages by being a purpose-driven leader in their industry
- Learn how firms can adjust their strategy to meet their broader stakeholders' needs
- Learn to understand challenges in implementing and sustaining purpose-driven strategies

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TEACHING METHODOLOGY

IE University teaching method is defined by its collaborative, active, and applied nature. Students actively participate in the whole process to build their knowledge and sharpen their skills. Professor's main role is to lead and guide students to achieve the learning objectives of the course. This is done by engaging in a diverse range of teaching techniques and different types of learning activities.

Learning Activity	Weighting	Estimated time a student should dedicate to prepare for and participate in
Lectures	33.3 %	50.0 hours
Discussions	23.3 %	35.0 hours
Exercises in class, Asynchronous sessions, Field Work	16.7 %	25.0 hours
Group work	13.3 %	20.0 hours
Individual studying	13.3 %	20.0 hours
TOTAL	100.0 %	150.0 hours

AI POLICY

Specific use cases of GenAI are encouraged in this course. This implies:

Generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools may be used in this course for the described acceptable use cases: ideation, proofreading, grammar check, and image generation with appropriate acknowledgement. GenAI may not be used for the ongoing evaluation quizzes and final exam. If a student is found to have used AI-generated content inappropriately, it will be considered academic misconduct, and the student might fail the respective assignment or the course.

If you are in doubt as to whether you are using GenAI tools appropriately in this course, I encourage you to discuss your situation with me.

Below, a suggested format to acknowledge the use of generative AI tools. Please note that acknowledging AI will not impact your grade.

> *"I acknowledge the use of [AI systems link] to [specify how you used generative AI]. The prompts used include [list of prompts]. The output of these prompts was used to [explain how you used the outputs in your work]"*

If AI was permitted to use in your assignment, but you have chosen not to include any AI generated content, the following disclosure is recommended:

"No content generated by AI technologies has been used in this assignment."

PROGRAM

SESSION 1 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Introduction

Chapter 1 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 2 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Value creation and capturing

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 2 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

Economics Primer (pages 9-25) and Chapter 9 (pages 279 292) from the Besanko textbook (Book) (See Bibliography)

SESSION 3 (ASYNCHRONOUS)

Exercise – Applying value creation and capturing

SESSION 4 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Industry analysis and the structure-conduct-performance paradigm

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 3 and the first paragraph (Does Industry Really Matter?) of Chapter 4 from Grant Textbook

Chapter 5 pages 155-162 and Chapter 8 pages 247-254 from Besanko Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 5 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Applying industry analysis

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

US Airlines, source: Grant Textbook

SESSION 6 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Industry segmentation and Blue Ocean strategy

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

R.A.: Blue Ocean Strategy: From Theory to Practice (CMR312-PDF-ENG)

Chapter 4 from Grant textbook (paragraph on Segmentation and Strategic Groups) (See Bibliography)

SESSION 7 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Resources and capabilities

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 5 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 8 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Applying the Resource-based-view

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Harley Davidson Case, source: Grant Textbook

SESSION 9 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Creating and sustaining competitive advantage

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 7 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

Economics Primer (pages 9-25) and Chapter 2 (pages 68-75) from Besanko Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 10 (ASYNCHRONOUS)

Exercise – Applying and understanding cost leadership

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 7 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 11 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Simulation - Applying and understanding benefit (differentiation) leadership

Practical Case : Arrogant Brewery (STR010104-U-ENG-HTM)

SESSION 12 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Competitive interactions and fundamentals of game theory

B.C.: Economics of Strategy (N/C)

Paragraph "Economics Primer" from Besanko Textbook (pages 29-21) (See Bibliography)

Additional notes from the professor

SESSIONS 13 - 14 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Simulation – Understanding competitive interactions in action (The Lobster simulation)

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Applying game theory to industrial organization

B.C.: Economics of Strategy (N/C)

B.C.: Economics of Strategy (N/C)

Instructions and Notes from the professor

Chapter 5 from the Besanko Textbook (pages 170-178) (See Bibliography)

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Chapter 6 and Chapter 11 (pages 364-367) from Besanko textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 15 (ASYNCHRONOUS)

Exercise – Applying the fundamentals of game theory

SESSION 16 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Game Theory - Applied

SESSION 17 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Strategic management of entry dynamics

SESSION 18 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Industry life cycles and strategic management in mature industries

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapters 8 and 10 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 19 (ASYNCHRONOUS)

Strategic management for improved environmental performance

Practical Case : Infosys Journey to Net-zero: A Scalable Path to Carbon Neutrality in Business (STR010266-U-ENG-HTM)

SESSION 20 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Understanding corporate strategy – Vertical integration

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 11 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 21 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Applying vertical integration

P.C.: THE LAO COFFEE INDUSTRY: IMPLEMENTING VERTICAL INTEGRATION FOR A SOCIAL CAUSE AT BOLAVEN FARMS (HKU933-PDF-ENG)

SESSION 22 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Understanding corporate strategy – Diversification

B.C.: Contemporary Strategy Analysis (N/C)

Chapter 13 from Grant Textbook (See Bibliography)

SESSION 23 (ASYNCHRONOUS)

Exercise – Applying diversification

Practical Case : Porsche AG. Beyond the limits of Luxury? (STR010106-U-ENG-HTM)

SESSION 24 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Tensions and benefits of combining financial, social and environmental objectives

Practical Case : Because There is No Planet B. The Case of Ecoalf (STR010114-U-ENG-WOD)

SESSION 25 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Strategic management and innovation

SESSION 26 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Guest speaker session

SESSIONS 27 - 28 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Case competition

SESSION 29 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Wrap up and conclusion

SESSION 30 (LIVE IN-PERSON)

Final exam

EVALUATION CRITERIA

Disclaimer: The assessment method may be subject to modifications. Should changes occur, students will be notified on the first day of class and provided with a written document detailing the modifications.

The evaluation of the class complies with the following rules:

- A necessary requirement to pass the course is to achieve **a minimum grade of 4.5 on the Final Exam**. If the minimum threshold of 4.5 is not reached, the course is to be evaluated as **FAILED**. Students will have to retake the exam in the extraordinary call in June/July and will lose their grades for the asynchronous assignments, case study competition, and participation.

- **Examinations cannot be rescheduled for any reason**. This applies to the Ongoing evaluation quizzes, the Final Exam, and the Case Study Competition. Students who do not show up to an examination will receive an evaluation equal to ‘zero’ for the respective examination. [The only exception for the Final Exam and every in-class evaluation is a dispensa or a justification from the BBA office provided upon the presentation of official (medical) documentation. If a justification is provided to skip the Final Exam, the student will take the exam in the extraordinary call of June/July.]

- In case of severe IT problems during an examination, the course coordination together with the strategy department chair can consider an ad-hoc alternative evaluation or exam. This includes the possibility of an oral exam.

The examination of the course will include the following elements that will be weighted according to the provided overview:

A. FINAL EXAM (45%): The Final Exam will test the content from Sessions 1 to 30 and includes the discussed content from the slides, indicated readings (incl. textbooks), case studies, and notes.

B. ONGOING EVALUATION QUIZZES (25%): The course contains 5 quizzes that test the content of the previous sessions. Quizzes are closed-book and individual examinations. They aim to allow students to receive an indication of how they are keeping up with the class content and "train" for the Final Exam. The quizzes will **take place in sessions 5, 11, 16, 20, 24 and and cannot be re-scheduled**. If a student misses a quiz, the missed quiz will be graded with 0. **From the 5 quizzes included in the class, the 4 best quizzes will count toward the final grade**, i.e. missing one quiz will not affect the final course grade.

C. CASE STUDY COMPETITION (15%): The case study competition will take place in sessions 27-28 and is a Group task. Students will be assigned a short business case with questions and are asked to provide well-grounded recommendations to solve the case in form of a presentation. The presentation has to include slides submitted via Blackboard. Grades will be ranked on a competitive basis.

D. PARTICIPATION (15%): Successful individual participation in class requires attendance and compliance with IE's and the class code of conduct. Participation is an individual grade and will be evaluated based on the following criteria:

1. **Depth and Quality of a student's contribution to the class**: High-quality comments distinguish by their depth of insight, rigorous use of case evidence, consistency of argument, and realism.

2. **Moving Your Peers' Understanding**: Great ideas can be lost through a poor presentation. A high-quality presentation of ideas is concise and clear and considers the relevance and timing of comments and the flow of the ensuing class discussion.

3. **Frequency**: Frequency refers to the attainment of a threshold quantity of contributions that is sufficient for making a reliable assessment of comment quality. Once a sufficient threshold quantity is met, increased "airtime" does not automatically improve your evaluation and evaluation depends on the comments' quality. Students are expected to make active attempts to contribute to the class debate regularly and not only wait for the instructor's invitation to contribute

criteria	percentage	Learning Objectives	Comments
Final Exam	45 %		
Intermediate tests	25 %		
Group Presentation	15 %		

Class Participation	15 %		

RE-SIT / RE-TAKE POLICY

*Each student has **four** chances to pass any given course distributed over two consecutive academic years: ordinary call exams and extraordinary call exams (re-sits) in June/July.*

***Resits:** Students failing the course in the ordinary call (during the semester) will have to re-sit the exam in June/July.*

*Those students who have not complied with the **80% attendance rule** during the semester will fail both calls for this Academic Year (ordinary and extraordinary) and will have to re-take the course (i.e., re-enroll) the following Academic Year, by paying the corresponding extra cost.*

*The June/July re-sit exam will consist of a comprehensive exam. Your final grade for the course will depend on the performance in this exam only; continuous evaluation over the semester will not be taken into consideration. Students will have to achieve the minimum passing grade of 5 and can obtain a maximum grade of **8.0 (out of 10.0)** in the re-sit exam.*

***Retakers:** Students who failed the subject in a previous Academic Year and are now re-enrolled as re-takers in a course will need to check the syllabus of the assigned professor, as well as contact the professor individually, regarding the specific evaluation criteria for them as retakers in the course during that semester (ordinary call of that Academic Year). The maximum grade that may be obtained in the retake exam (3rd call) is 10.0*

*Retake students in undergraduate programs are **generally** not required to attend classes; **however, certain courses may still apply attendance requirements depending on the course methodology or specific learning objectives**. Each syllabus clearly indicates whether attendance is mandatory or not for retake students. Therefore, it's always the student's responsibility to make sure to **check the syllabus for the specific conditions for retake students** and to **contact the professor at the start of the semester** in order to find out what is required of him /her to best prepare for the retake and to pass the course. This is very important since each professor has his/her own specific requirements.*

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Compulsory

- Robert M Grant. (2024). *Contemporary strategy analysis : text and cases.* 12th. Wiley & Sons Ltd.. ISBN 9781394251599 (Digital) eBook

- David Besanko. (2017). *Economics of strategy.* 7th Edition. Wiley. ISBN 9781119378761 (Digital) eBook

BEHAVIOR RULES

Please, check the University's Academic Integrity Policy here. The Program Director may provide further indications.

ATTENDANCE POLICY

Please, check the University's Attendance Policy here. The Program Director may provide further indications.

ETHICAL POLICY

Please, check the University's Student Code of conduct here. The Program Director may provide further indications.